were tired of tracking the Mirzas' unrepentant trail.

Whatever the cause of Muhammad Husain's impromptu execution, it had its desired effect. The last surviving Mirza, Shah, left the pages of the narrative 'and became a desert-wandering vagabond'[61] till the end of his days. His Timurid cousins would never trouble Akbar again.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), vol. 2, trans. Henry Beveridge (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017).

. Nizamuddin Ahmad, 'Tabakat-i Akbari', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 5 (Trübner and Co., 1873).

. Fr. Antonio Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate, S.J. on his Journey to the Court of Akbar*, trans. J.S. Hoyland, annotations S.N. Banerjee (Oxford University Press, 1922).

. 'The pious King, who used not to make any other requests to God, became a wisher for this great boon.' See *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*.

. Chester Beatty / Wikimedia Commons: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Balchand._Akbar_inspecting_construction_for_his_new_capital_Fatehpur_Sikri,_Akbarnama,_1603-5,_Chester_Beatty_Library.jpg

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Abdul Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (first published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990

. Nor was it Muzaffar Khan's love for 'a young man', thwarted by Akbar two years earlier. At the time, the accountant had declared himself a dervish, renouncing the world to tend to his broken heart; but he returned, evidently, and there seem to have been no hard feelings on either side. The beloved's fate is unrecorded. See *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014). The historian adds that if any player 'lost his patience and got restless, he had to drink a cup of wine'.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2.

. Ibid.

. Itimad Khan had been making overtures to Akbar for a while, it seems. When the padishah was besieging Chittorgarh, he received a gift from the Gujarati khan: a 'sea-elephant' – presumably from Africa – 'which had exceedingly long ears' (*The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 2).

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Editor's note in Shaikh Illahdad Faizi Sirhindi, 'Akbarnama', in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 6 (Trübner and Co., 1875).

. Stephen F. Dale, *The Muslim Empires of the Ottomans, Safavids, and Mughals* (Cambridge University Press, 2010).

. Shaikh Illahdad Faizi Sirhindi, *Akbarnama*.

. See Afzal Husain, *The Nobility under Akbar and Jahangir: A Study of Family Groups* (Manohar Publishers, 1999).

. Victoria and Albert Museum: https://collections.vam.ac.uk/item/O9594/akbar-painting-mahesh

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. Ibid.

. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.

. Ibid.